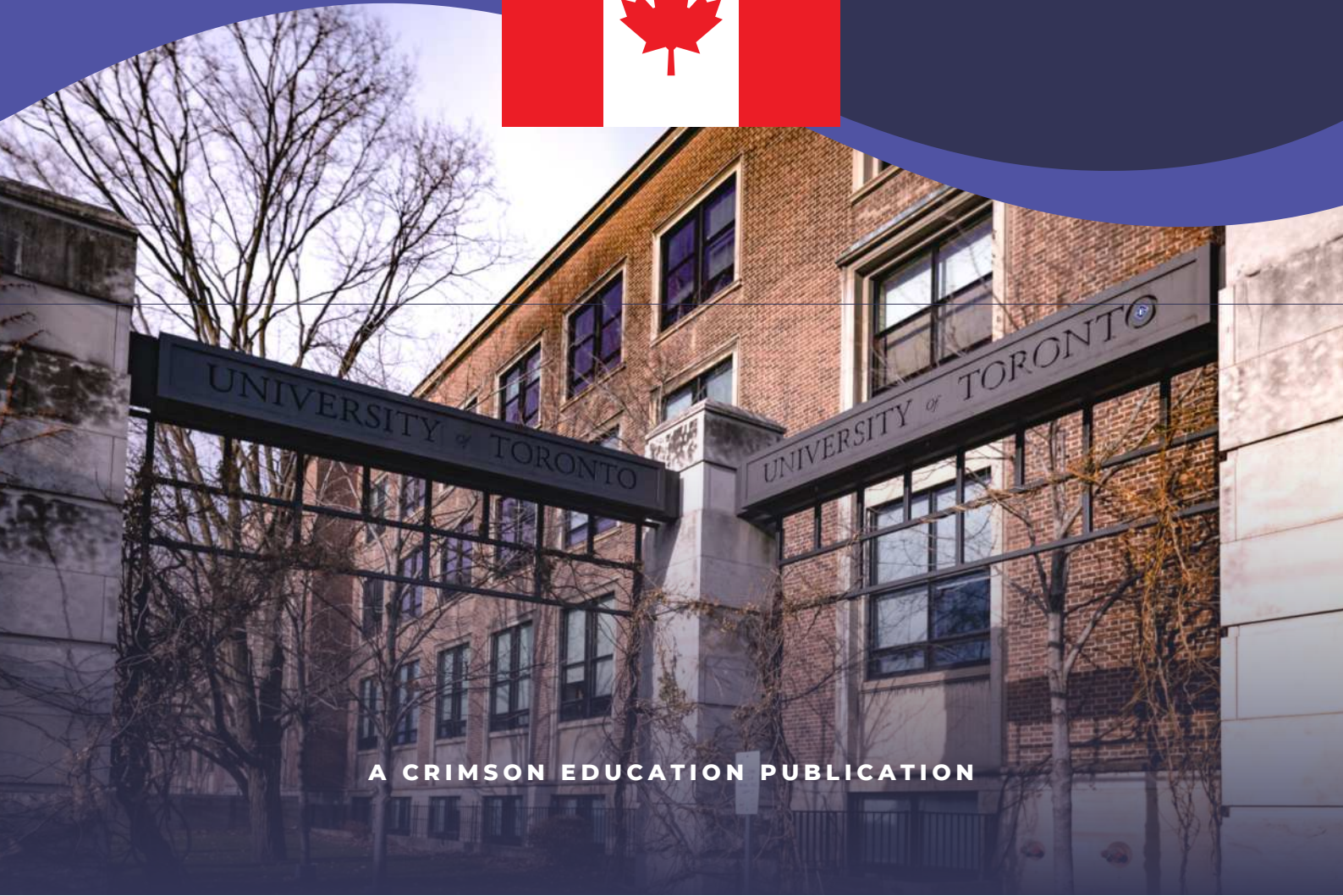




The Ultimate Guide to

Canada University Admissions

Everything students need to know about getting into the
most competitive universities in Canada!



A CRIMSON EDUCATION PUBLICATION

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Introduction

Sitting alongside the United Kingdom and the United States, Canada is an increasingly popular destination for international students. It's not hard to see why, with Canadian universities being amongst the best in the world. The allure of an experience that promises the best of both worlds — an exciting mix of big cities and vast beautiful countryside — is undeniable.

But how do you get started on the path to your dream university? What are the Canadian university requirements? What deadlines should you be looking out for? How should you start preparing now, regardless of which grade you're in, to kickstart your journey to your dream school?

If you're a student applying for undergraduate studies in Canada, this eBook will answer all your questions! We'll give you guidelines on application timelines and entrance exams, how to choose which university to go to, and exclusive tips for getting into renowned schools like University of Toronto and McGill University.

By the time you're done reading this eBook, you'll be well on your way to your dream university.

Happy reading, and good luck!



Why Canada?

01. *It's Cost Effective*

- + The cost of Canadian Universities is significantly lower than their US counterparts
- + The tuition range is roughly 50,000 - 65,000 CAD

02. *Many Post-Graduate Options*

- + International students with a Canadian degree will qualify for a Work Permit that is valid up to 3 years after graduation
- + You can work on a path towards Permanent Residence

03. *Academic Priority Admissions*

- + The admissions process mostly focuses on academic merit. Students in rigorous curricula applying to Canada are therefore highly competitive.

04. *Multicultural Mosaic*

- + Canada is officially bilingual (English and French), with several languages in the mix (Mandarin, Cantonese, Punjabi)
- + More than one in five Canadians were born abroad, making the country incredibly diverse
- + Toronto, McGill and UBC are all located in major cities
- + Canada welcomes over 120,000 international students each year

05. *High Quality of Life*

- + In 2018, The Global Peace Index listed Canada as the sixth most peaceful country across the globe
- + Canada has a reputation for being an incredibly welcoming space to international students, with a new International Education Strategy (IES) being implemented to better support international students



Canadian Universities & Degrees: An Overview

TYPES OF UNIVERSITY

Public Universities

Public universities receive funding from the government. They tend to follow province-wide admissions requirements, or have their own individual campus requirements. They are also usually less expensive than private institutions.

Private Universities

A private university usually receives private funding through faculty research grants, donations from wealthy alumni as well as from tuition fees, instead of funding from the government.

Liberal Arts Universities

Similar to the USA, liberal arts universities place an emphasis on undergraduate courses in the liberal arts. The Liberal Arts curriculum explores issues, ideas and methods across the humanities and the arts, as well as the natural and social sciences.

College & Polytechnic Institutions

These are Canadian institutions of higher education providing technical, applied, hands-on learning — offering applied degrees, diplomas, certificates and apprenticeship training.

The Two Different Types of Canadian Degrees



1) Academic Degrees

Canada sits in what could be called a 'sweet spot' between the US system and the UK system of higher education. Where, like the British system, applicants apply to a course of study, but they also have the flexibility to build their own path to the degree. Students are expected to take around 5 courses per semester, and these classes make up the degree programme. Typically, each course is made up weekly of two hours of lectures and a one hour tutorial where a teaching assistant leads a discussion based around that lecture or the week's reading.



2) Diplomas / Applied Degrees

Diplomas in Canada combine the academic focus of a university degree with the practical, job-ready skills students learn in college. A number of colleges and technical institutes across Canada, as well as some universities and university colleges, have introduced Diplomas to respond to today's demanding job market. Diplomas help fill the need for educated and highly-skilled workers by producing graduates who bring a strong combination of technical and theoretical skills to the job.

Canadian University Landscape

Finding your best fit

Canada is home to some of the most respected and well-known educational institutions in the world.



The leading universities in **Canada**



University of
Toronto



McGill
University



University of
British Columbia



Université de
Montréal



University of
Alberta



McMaster
University



University of
Waterloo



Western
University

Beyond the top 8, you can find other leading universities including:



University of
Ottawa



University of
Calgary



Queen's
University



Dalhousie
University



Simon Fraser
University



University of
Victoria



Université
Laval



University
of Saskatchewan



The "Big Three"

Canada is mostly known for the Big Three: the University of Toronto, McGill University and the University of British Columbia.

These top three universities in Canada can be more appealing than their US and UK counterparts, for several reasons. Firstly, it can be significantly cheaper for international students, with tuition at top Canadian universities 16-38% cheaper than their US counterparts.

Simultaneously, acceptance rates at Canada's top schools are approximately 3 times higher than in the US and UK. This may be attractive to those seeking to increase their chances of admission to a top-ranked university.

These higher rates of acceptance appear to be a result of government incentives, rather than low academic quality. For example, public universities in Canada receive funding based on the number of students enrolled, while public universities in the U.S. are typically funded on a lump sum basis. These incentive structures appear to motivate Canadian universities to expand their incoming classes more so than U.S. schools.

This makes the top three universities in Canada particularly enticing to international students, as they are able to provide a world-class education with fewer barriers to entry and at a much lower cost.

Quick Overview

University	Yearly Tuition Fees (CAD)	Average GPA of Accepted Applicants	QS World Ranking
University of Toronto	\$57,070 - \$60,510	3.70	26
McGill University	\$34,613 - \$58,949	3.75	27
University of British Columbia	\$42,694 - \$55,384	3.56	46

UNIVERSITY OF TORONTO

 **Toronto, Canada**

Founded in 1827, the University of Toronto has evolved into Canada's leading institution of learning, discovery and knowledge creation. The University of Toronto is one of the world's top research-intensive universities, driven to invent and innovate.

The school has three campuses – St. George, Mississauga and Scarborough – located in and around Toronto. Roughly 95 percent of the university's graduate students study at the downtown St. George campus, as do upward of 60 percent of its undergraduates. Thousands of foreign students from more than 160 countries and regions attend the University of Toronto.

UNIVERSITY OF TORONTO ADMISSION STATS



Average
Acceptance Rate

43%

Average
IB Score*

34
with English
HL or SL

Average
A Level Grades*

AAB **A*AB**
for arts for science/
commerce

*minimum grades are the absolute minimum entry requirement, and students should always aim to be more competitive

UOT BY THE NUMBERS



#26

QS World
University ranking

#16

US News
ranking

700

Undergraduate
fields of study

35:1

Student-
Faculty ratio

Jan 13

Application
Deadline

28%

Percentage of
international
students

\$55,000 CAD

Median starting
salary for graduates

UOT'S MOST POPULAR MAJORS



- 01** Architecture
- 02** Biology
- 03** Commerce & Management
- 04** Computer Science
- 05** Humanities & Social Science
- 06** Kinesiology and Physical Education

? DID YOU KNOW? ?

The University of Toronto library system is the third largest in North America.

MCGILL UNIVERSITY

 **Montreal, Quebec**

McGill University is an English-language public research university located in Montreal, Quebec, Canada. Founded in 1821 by royal charter granted by King George IV, the university bears the name of James McGill.

McGill's main campus is on the slope of Mount Royal in downtown Montreal in the borough of Ville-Marie, with a second campus situated in Sainte-Anne-de-Bellevue, 30 kilometres (19 mi) west of the main campus on Montreal Island, and a third francophone medical campus in Gatineau, Quebec.

MCGILL ADMISSION STATS



Average
Acceptance Rate

47%

Average
IB Scores*

34

for
arts

38

for science
/commerce

Average
A Level Grades*

AAB

for
arts

AAA

for
science/
commerce

*minimum grades are the absolute minimum entry requirement, and students should always aim to be more competitive

MCGILL BY THE NUMBERS



#27

QS World
University ranking

#51

US News
ranking

300

Undergraduate
fields of study

14:1

Student-
Faculty ratio

Jan 15

Application
Deadline

32%

Percentage of
international
students

\$53,000 CAD

Median starting
salary for graduates

MCGILL'S MOST POPULAR MAJORS



- 01** Science
- 02** Medicine & Health Sciences
- 03** Engineering
- 04** Art (Drama & Theatre)
- 05** Management
- 06** Education

? DID YOU KNOW? ?

The creation of the first artificial blood cell is among the research achievements associated with the McGill.

UNIVERSITY OF BRITISH COLUMBIA

 **Vancouver, Canada**

The University of British Columbia is a public research university located in the Canadian province of British Columbia. With an annual research budget of \$759 million, UBC funds over 8,000 projects a year. The university was established in 1908 and opened in 1915.

It has two main campuses – the Vancouver campus and the Okanagan campus located in Kelowna. The Vancouver campus is the larger of the two, accommodating more than 85 percent of UBC students. In a recent year, 23 percent of students at the Vancouver campus and around 13 percent at the Okanagan campus were international.

BRITISH COLUMBIA ADMISSION STATS



Average
Acceptance Rate

52%

Average
IB Score*

33
with English
HL or SL

Average
A Level Grades*

AAB **AAB**
for arts for science/
commerce

*minimum grades are the absolute minimum entry requirement, and students should always aim to be more competitive

BRITISH COLUMBIA BY THE NUMBERS



#46

QS World
University ranking

#35

US News
ranking

257

Undergraduate
fields of study

10:1

Student-
Faculty ratio

Jan 15

Application
Deadline

24%

Percentage of
international
students

\$53,500 CAD

Median starting
salary for graduates

BRITISH COLUMBIA'S MOST POPULAR MAJORS



- 01** Medicine
- 02** Biotechnology
- 03** Economics
- 04** Behavioural Neuroscience
- 05** Forestry
- 06** Transportation
Science & Technology

? DID YOU KNOW? ?

UBC's Vancouver campus is the ninth most popular filming location on earth. (The X-Files, Legion, Supernatural, etc)

The Admissions Process

Unlike the US and the UK, Canada has no centralised admissions platform. You usually need to apply to each university individually, however some provinces may have unique centralised platforms.

You will need to choose and apply for a specific major when applying for university in Canada but unlike the UK, this tends to be more flexible if you change your mind.

Having found the right course, it's necessary to look at the deadlines and requirements. Since Canada does not have a centralised admissions platform, admissions requirements can vary from province to province, as well as from university to university!

It is important to find out as much as you can about the universities you are considering, to make sure you make the best possible choice. Don't be afraid to contact officials who deal with international students at the universities you're interested in and to ask them questions. Also, make sure you give yourself plenty of time to apply and to get a study permit, as the application process varies widely from course to course, and university to university.



Academic Requirements

- + School official transcript/academic profile (A-Level, IB or GPA)
- + English language qualifications (TOEFL, IELTS)*
*(Depends on the university / the high school the student attended. Usually IB and A-Level students can get exemptions, and students in international schools (where the language of instruction is English) can apply for a waiver)
- + Course specific, prerequisite subjects
- + Proof of standardised tests*
*(Unlike the US, Canadian universities don't tend to rely on standardised tests. However, some universities in Canada will have them as a requirement - for example, the University of Toronto)



Non-Academic Requirements

- + Applying for a study permit
- + Extracurriculars & volunteering (depending on program)
- + Teacher References



Personal Statement & Interviews (when required)

- + Demonstrating competency and curiosity about your intended field of study
- + Putting your achievements in context



Application Deadlines

- + The university application process starts in the fall of the year before you intend to begin your studies.

Application Process Overview

**September/
October**

Fill in online application form

**January/
February**

Submit all the required documents

March/May

Response is sent by the university

May/July

Apply for and obtain a student visa to Canada

**August/
September**

Orientation session, program commences

Region-Specific Application Portals

In Canada, the application portals are decentralised, based on province, and operate in phases. For example, to apply to universities and colleges based in Ontario, the admissions platform you use is the OUAC. Thus, It is worth checking the entry requirements of each individual institution.

Ontario Universities Application Centre (OUAC)

Ontario has the largest number of universities and colleges out of any province. Thus, it has its own application system, the OUAC.

Firstly, make an online account on the OUAC website's service. From there, upload the necessary transcripts, documents, and other information required for your application. You will also be able to view information on the schools and programs that you might want to apply for, including the application requirements for those programs.

The OUAC application has several components that help flesh out your application, making sure that the schools you are applying to have a better idea of who you are.

Aside from your personal and contact information, it includes a section for your academic history, high school transcripts, and sections related to the programs you've selected.

These sections are not mandatory for the OUAC, but certain programs may require them so it is important that you read the instructions carefully and fill them out if necessary.

Since there are several platforms, it can sometimes be a little complicated. If you have any questions, our crimson advisors would be happy to answer them — contact us!





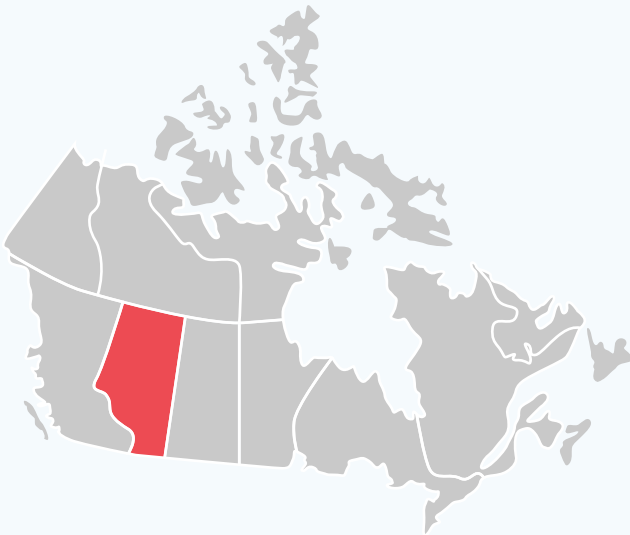
This is the system through which students can apply to all universities in the province of Alberta. As you would expect, the website contains lots of helpful resources for international students looking to apply to a university in Alberta.

Not all universities and colleges are participants of the program, so if you do not see the school you're interested in on ApplyAlberta's website, you will need to apply directly through the institution in question.



British Columbia's application site, EducationPlannerBC, allows students to explore undergraduate, postgraduate and apprenticeship opportunities.

It is very similar to the Common App system. Most of the institutions and universities in the province use this system, including the University of British Columbia and the University of Victoria . The only exceptions are a few private BC institutions like the British Columbia Institute of Technology and Royal Roads University.



How do you choose?

Canada is huge, providing several options for international students looking to apply to a Canadian university. When given so many choices, it can be quite difficult to decide which university would be the best fit. This section covers the factors that should be considered when determining a student's "fit" for a Canadian university:



Location, location, location!

Canada has a mix of remote rural locations and vibrant, global cities. So it's worth asking yourself: what's the best learning environment for me? Do I prefer exploring big cities? Is it better to live in a quieter country area, but also have city amenities nearby?



Admissions requirements

Some Canadian universities focus purely on academic achievements, whereas a select few also consider extracurriculars and supplemental essays. It is important to then play to your strengths, and choose universities that have a greater likelihood of you getting in.



Living costs

It's important to always remember how expansive Canada is. It's quite easy to forget that there are significant differences in living cost depending on the city you choose to live in. How much will transport, food and accommodation cost on top of tuition?



Subject rankings

Certain Canadian universities can be well-renowned for certain types of programs. Thus, it can be easier to map your way after you choose your subject of focus, by looking at these rankings (such as QS World University Rankings, US News University Rankings, etc).



Travel costs & accessibility

As an international student, there is a high likelihood you would choose to fly home for the holidays. Therefore, it's important to consider the cost and availability of flights to return home.



Weather

Adjusting to changes in climate can be harder than you think! Parts of Canada can be very cold, even during the summer. So, if you are seeking a warmer climate, it's best to look at universities and campuses situated closer to the US border.

Final Thoughts

We hope this eBook gave you the pointers you need to start planning your journey to your dream university in Canada! If you made it this far, you're probably serious about pursuing a degree from a top Canadian university — and we're ready to help.

Standing out from a crowd of tens of thousands of other applicants isn't easy. As you know from reading our overview of the Canadian university admissions process, there's a lot to do (and to perfect!). Don't embark on this process — one of the most important journeys of your life thus far — alone.

To learn more about your university options and what a top Canadian university education can do for your future, [visit our website to schedule a free consultation](#) with one of our expert academic advisors. From finding your best fit university to clicking “submit” on your applications, we've got you covered every step of the way!



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Ready to Get Started?

Book in a free one hour consultation with one of our expert Academic Advisors who can answer all your individual questions and create a plan for you or your child.

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